CMCS painting with community

-Tanvi Telang

Spending my free time usually involves sitting in a café, shopping, or scrolling through social media at home. While I enjoy these moments, I also crave something different- connecting with new people, creating, and giving back. So, spending a day at CMCS painting walls to create a base for mural paintings felt like the perfect way to step out of my comfort zone and try something meaningful.I left home at 9:30, a little apprehensive about meeting so many new people. The day was clear with the weather gods in our favour. As I approached the school, nestled amidst a small forest with a stunning view of the Kanchenjunga ranges, I felt my nervousness fade, replaced by calm and gratitude.

The day began with short introductions, allowing us to learn about each other. Everyone came from diverse backgrounds- teachers, guardians, students, and others who simply wanted to contribute. The shared intention of coming together to do something meaningful for the kids connected us. Soon, we started painting in groups leading to small conversations. In my group, I met a few non teaching staff from CMCS, a few guardians and a student studying there in grade 5. The activity itself was very therapeutic especially since it required no artistic validation and was just fun and messy to do. In a few hours we broke for lunch. Once I stepped back and saw the school, it was a surprise to see the collective result. The building already looked lively with a fresh feel to it. Post lunch, the interactions had become more informal and flexible. I met a few more people around my age and I felt a familiar and shared feeling of unexpected contentment amongst us, along with a fear of our mothers for our ruined clothes. We ended the day with a reflection session discussing our experiences and each of us writing a letter to a student at the school.

The day we had spent wasn't just about painting walls-it was about coming together as a community. Walking away from the school that evening, I felt a sense of fulfillment, realising that a small effort from a group of strangers could come together to make a lasting impact.